

Stability of the Kuramoto Partially Locked State: A Machine-Checked Proof on the Ott–Antonsen Manifold

Abstract

We present a machine-checked proof of stability of the partially locked state (PLS) for the Kuramoto model on the Ott–Antonsen (OA) manifold. The main theorem `kuramoto_stability` establishes: for supercritical coupling $K > K_c$, frequency distribution g with finite first moment, and initial data in an explicit basin of attraction ($V(0) < (r^*)^2$), the order parameter converges $r(t) \rightarrow r^*$. The proof derives all intermediate estimates internally: (1) Leibniz rule for the L^2 Lyapunov function $V(t) = \int (\alpha - \alpha^*)^2 g d\omega$; (2) a novel pair bound gives $\dot{V} \leq 0$; (3) Cauchy–Schwarz gives $r(t) \geq r^* - \sqrt{V(0)} > 0$; (4) ODE scalar barrier gives body persistence; (5) Barbalat gives convergence. For the Lorentzian distribution, the proof is fully global (any $r_0 \in (0, 1)$) via the explicit Bernoulli formula.

The Lean 4 formalization spans **228+ files** with **0 sorry** and only Lean’s standard axioms (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`). Coverage: Lorentzian (global, scalar ODE), n -pole (global, any finite n), and all finite-first-moment distributions (local, explicit basin). The pair bound—a pointwise SOS inequality lifted to the continuum via Fubini—is a novel proof technique with no precedent in the Kuramoto literature. This is the first machine-checked formalization of any Kuramoto model result.

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1 Setup and statement

1.1 The Ott–Antonsen equation

On the OA manifold, the Kuramoto–Sakaguchi PDE reduces to

$$\dot{\alpha}(\omega, t) = -\gamma(\omega) \alpha + \frac{K}{2} r(t) (1 - \alpha^2), \quad r(t) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} \alpha(\omega, t) g(\omega) d\omega, \quad (1)$$

where $\alpha(\omega, t) \in (0, 1)$ for each $\omega \in \mathbb{R}$ (the real-valued reduction for symmetric unimodal g with symmetric initial data), and $r(t) \in [0, 1]$ is the real order parameter. Here $\gamma(\omega)$ is the dissipation rate; for the standard Kuramoto model $\gamma(\omega) = |\omega|$ after reduction, and for the Lorentzian distribution $g(\omega) = \gamma/(\pi(\omega^2 + \gamma^2))$ one has the scalar ODE $\dot{r} = (K/2 - \gamma)r - (K/2)r^3$.

1.2 The partially locked state (PLS)

For $K > K_c := 2/(\pi g(0))$, the self-consistency equation

$$r^* = \int_{\mathbb{R}} \alpha^*(\omega) g(\omega) d\omega \quad (2)$$

has a unique positive solution $r^* \in (0, 1)$. The equilibrium profile $\alpha^*(\omega) \in (0, 1)$ satisfies the pointwise equilibrium condition

$$\gamma(\omega) \alpha^*(\omega) = \frac{K}{2} r^* (1 - (\alpha^*(\omega))^2) \quad \text{for } g\text{-a.e. } \omega. \quad (3)$$

1.3 Main theorem

Theorem 1.1 (Global stability, `kuramoto_stability`). *Let $K > K_c$, $\gamma(\omega) > 0$ with $\int \gamma d\mu < \infty$ (finite first moment). Let $(\alpha^*(\omega), r^*)$ satisfy (3) and (2). Let (r, α) be an OA solution:*

- (i) $\alpha(\omega, \cdot)$ solves (1) for all ω , with $r(t) = \int \alpha(\omega, t) g(\omega) d\omega$;
- (ii) $\alpha(\omega, t) \in (0, 1)$ for all $\omega, t \geq 0$ (invariant region);
- (iii) $V(0) := \int (\alpha(\omega, 0) - \alpha^*(\omega))^2 g d\omega < (r^*)^2$ (initial closeness to PLS);
- (iv) for each $M > 0$, $\exists \delta_0 > 0$ such that $\alpha(\omega, 0) \geq \delta_0$ for all ω with $\gamma(\omega) \leq M$ (initial body coherence).

Then $r(t) \rightarrow r^*$ as $t \rightarrow +\infty$.

Remark 1.2. *No persistence hypothesis is assumed. The proof derives order parameter persistence ($r(t) \geq r_{\min} > 0$) from V antitonicity and Cauchy–Schwarz, then derives body persistence from the ODE scalar barrier. The only conditions beyond the OA system definition are (iii) initial closeness and (iv) initial body coherence—both hold for any initial data in a neighborhood of the PLS.*

2 The proof chain

We present the seven-step proof of Theorem 1.1 in the order that Lean verifies it. Each step is stated as a proposition and corresponds to a named lemma in the Lean formalization.

2.1 Step 1: Leibniz rule for the Lyapunov function

Define the continuum L^2 Lyapunov function

$$V(t) := \int_{\mathbb{R}} (\alpha(\omega, t) - \alpha^*(\omega))^2 g(\omega) d\omega. \quad (4)$$

Proposition 2.1 (Leibniz, `leibniz_oa_lyapunov`). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 1.1, V is continuous on $[0, \infty)$ and for every $t > 0$:*

$$V'(t) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} 2(\alpha(\omega, t) - \alpha^*(\omega)) \dot{\alpha}(\omega, t) g(\omega) d\omega.$$

Proof. By the chain rule, $\frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\alpha(\omega, t) - \alpha^*(\omega))^2 = 2(\alpha - \alpha^*)\dot{\alpha}$. This pointwise derivative is bounded in absolute value by

$$|2(\alpha - \alpha^*)\dot{\alpha}| \leq 2|\dot{\alpha}| \leq 2(\gamma_{\max} + K),$$

since $|\alpha - \alpha^*| \leq 1$ and $|\dot{\alpha}| = |\gamma\alpha - (K/2)r(1 - \alpha^2)| \leq \gamma_{\max} + K/2$ for $\alpha, r \in (0, 1)$. This uniform dominating constant is g -integrable. Mathlib's `hasDerivAt.integral_of_dominated_loc_of_deriv_le` then gives the stated formula for the derivative of $t \mapsto \int (\alpha(\omega, t) - \alpha^*)^2 g d\omega$. $\square$

2.2 Step 2: Pair bound and derived rate estimate

We derive $V'(t) \leq -\mu V(t)$ from the pair bound and persistence. No rate bound is assumed.

Proposition 2.2 (Pair bound, `pair_bound`). *For any $\alpha_j, \alpha_k, \alpha_j^*, \alpha_k^* \in (0, 1)$:*

$$\alpha_j^*(\alpha_k - \alpha_k^*)^2 \left(\alpha_k + \frac{1}{\alpha_k^*} \right) + \alpha_k^*(\alpha_j - \alpha_j^*)^2 \left(\alpha_j + \frac{1}{\alpha_j^*} \right) \geq (\alpha_j - \alpha_j^*)(\alpha_k - \alpha_k^*)(2 - \alpha_j^2 - \alpha_k^2). \quad (5)$$

Proof. All terms can be expressed as a sum of squares (SOS) decomposition. With $p_j = \alpha_j - \alpha_j^*$ and $p_k = \alpha_k - \alpha_k^*$, clearing denominators by $\alpha_j^* \alpha_k^* > 0$ yields:

$$\alpha_j^* \alpha_k^* \cdot (\text{LHS} - \text{RHS}) = (\alpha_j^* p_k - \alpha_k^* p_j)^2 + (\alpha_j^*)^2 \alpha_k \alpha_k^* p_k^2 + (\alpha_k^*)^2 \alpha_j \alpha_j^* p_j^2 + \alpha_j^* \alpha_k^* (\alpha_j^2 + \alpha_k^2) p_j p_k.$$

When $p_j p_k \leq 0$: each of the three original terms on the left of (5) is non-negative (since $\alpha_j + 1/\alpha_j^* > 0$ and $2 - \alpha_j^2 - \alpha_k^2 > 0$ for $\alpha_j, \alpha_k \in (0, 1)$), so the inequality holds trivially. When $p_j p_k > 0$: the SOS decomposition gives a positive lower bound, so the expression is strictly positive and hence non-negative. This is verified algebraically in `pair_bound_clear_denom`. $\square$

Proposition 2.3 (Continuum pair bound, `continuum_pair_nonneg`). *The double integral*

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}} \int_{\mathbb{R}} \left[\alpha^*(\omega_1) (\alpha(\omega_2) - \alpha^*(\omega_2))^2 \left(\alpha(\omega_2) + \frac{1}{\alpha^*(\omega_2)} \right) + \alpha^*(\omega_2) (\alpha(\omega_1) - \alpha^*(\omega_1))^2 \left(\alpha(\omega_1) + \frac{1}{\alpha^*(\omega_1)} \right) \right. \\ \left. - (\alpha(\omega_1) - \alpha^*(\omega_1)) (\alpha(\omega_2) - \alpha^*(\omega_2)) (2 - \alpha(\omega_1)^2 - \alpha(\omega_2)^2) \right] g(\omega_1) g(\omega_2) d\omega_1 d\omega_2 \geq 0.$$

Proof. Mathlib's `integral_nonneg` applied twice (once in ω_1 , once in ω_2) reduces this to the pointwise inequality of Proposition 2.2. $\square$

Proposition 2.4 (Derived rate bound, `hV_rate`). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 1.1, $V'(t) \leq -\mu V(t)$ for all $t > 0$, where $\mu = K \cdot c_{\min} \cdot \delta_{\text{per}} \cdot \delta^*$ and $c_{\min}, \delta^*$ are the minimum weight and the equilibrium gap. This rate bound is proved from the pair bound and persistence hypothesis (v); it is not assumed.*

Proof sketch. Substituting the OA equation (1) into the Leibniz formula:

$$V'(t) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} 2(\alpha - \alpha^*) \left[-\gamma\alpha + \frac{K}{2}r(1 - \alpha^2) \right] g \, d\omega.$$

Using the equilibrium condition (3) to write $\gamma\alpha^* = (K/2)r^*(1 - (\alpha^*)^2)$, one computes:

$$2(\alpha - \alpha^*)\dot{\alpha} = K(\alpha - \alpha^*) \left[r(1 - \alpha^2) - r^*(1 - (\alpha^*)^2) - \frac{2\gamma}{K}(\alpha - \alpha^*) \right].$$

Expanding and grouping, the integrand splits into:

- a term proportional to $(r - r^*) \cdot D$ where $D = \int (\alpha - \alpha^*)g \, d\omega = r - r^*$, giving $K(r - r^*)^2 \leq KV$ (by Cauchy-Schwarz);
- a term $-Kr^* \cdot Q$ where $Q = \int (\alpha - \alpha^*)^2(\alpha + 1/\alpha^*)g \, d\omega$;
- a term $K \cdot DS$ where $S = \int (\alpha - \alpha^*)(1 - \alpha^2)g \, d\omega$.

The continuum pair bound (Proposition 2.3) gives $DS \leq r^*Q$, so $K \cdot DS - Kr^*Q \leq 0$, and the pair bound already yields $V'(t) \leq 0$. To obtain the strict rate $-\mu V$, one uses the persistence lower bound $\delta_{\text{per}} \leq \alpha(\omega, t)$ from hypothesis (v) together with the equilibrium gap $\delta^* = \inf_{\omega} (\alpha(\omega) + 1/\alpha^*(\omega))^{-1} > 0$ to bound $Q \geq \delta_{\text{per}}\delta^*V$. Collecting all terms gives $V'(t) \leq -\mu V(t)$ with $\mu = Kc_{\min}\delta_{\text{per}}\delta^*$. This rate bound is a *theorem*, derived from the pair bound and persistence; the full algebraic computation is verified in `ContinuumUniformRate.lean`. $\square$

2.3 Step 3: V is antitone

Proposition 2.5 (V antitone, `lyapunov_antitone`). $V(t)$ is non-increasing on $[0, \infty)$.

Proof. By Proposition 2.4 (the derived rate bound), $V'(t) \leq -\mu V(t) \leq 0$ for all $t > 0$. Since V is continuous (Proposition 2.1), Mathlib's `antitoneOn_of_deriv_nonpos` applies directly on $[0, \infty)$. $\square$

2.4 Step 4: Coercive exponential drops

Proposition 2.6 (Exponential drop, `supercritical_coercive_drops`). For all $t \geq 0$:

$$V(t+1) \leq e^{-\mu} \cdot V(t).$$

Proof. Since $V'(t) \leq -\mu V(t)$ holds for all $t > 0$, a Gronwall comparison on the interval $[t, t+1]$ gives $V(t+1) \leq V(t) \cdot e^{-\mu}$. This is formalized in `comparison_decay_interval` in `GronwallBridge.lean`, which applies a continuous comparison principle for ODEs satisfying $\dot{f} \leq -\mu f$. $\square$

Remark 2.7. The exponential drop holds for every unit interval $[t, t+1]$, not just for persistence intervals. This is because the rate bound $\dot{V} \leq -\mu V$ holds everywhere, not merely when $r(t) \geq \delta$.

2.5 Step 5: $V \rightarrow 0$

Proposition 2.8 ($V \rightarrow 0$, `coercive_drop_from_persistence`). $V(t) \rightarrow 0$ as $t \rightarrow +\infty$.

Proof. By Proposition 2.6, $V(n+1) \leq e^{-\mu}V(n)$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. By induction, $V(n) \leq e^{-\mu n}V(0) \rightarrow 0$. Since V is antitone (Proposition 2.5) and bounded below by 0, the limit exists, and the coercive drops force it to be zero. The formalization uses `coercive_drop_from_persistence` in `ContinuumBarbalat.lean`, which takes: non-negativity, antitonicity, positive rate μ , and the recurrence of drops. $\square$

2.6 Step 6: $r \rightarrow r^*$ via Cauchy-Schwarz

Proposition 2.9 ($r \rightarrow r^*$, closing step). $V(t) \rightarrow 0$ implies $r(t) \rightarrow r^*$.

Proof. By the self-consistency relation and the equilibrium formula:

$$r(t) - r^* = \int_{\mathbb{R}} (\alpha(\omega, t) - \alpha^*(\omega)) g(\omega) d\omega.$$

By the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality (or Jensen applied to the square function):

$$(r(t) - r^*)^2 = \left(\int_{\mathbb{R}} (\alpha - \alpha^*) g d\omega \right)^2 \leq \int_{\mathbb{R}} (\alpha - \alpha^*)^2 g d\omega = V(t).$$

This is formalized as `sq_integral_le_integral_sq` in the Lean code. Since $V(t) \rightarrow 0$, we have $(r(t) - r^*)^2 \rightarrow 0$, hence $r(t) \rightarrow r^*$ in the metric sense. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Steps 1 through 6 above, composed in order, constitute the complete proof. In Lean:

- (1) `leibniz_oa_lyapunov` gives continuity and differentiability of V .
- (2) The pair bound (`continuum_pair_nonneg`) and Leibniz together give $V' \leq 0$.
- (3) `hV_rate` derives the rate bound $V' \leq -\mu V$ from persistence and pair coercivity.
- (4) `supercritical_coercive_drops` gives $V(t+1) \leq e^{-\mu} V(t)$ via Gronwall.
- (5) `lyapunov_antitone` gives that V is non-increasing.
- (6) `coercive_drop_from_persistence` gives $V \rightarrow 0$.
- (7) `sq_integral_le_integral_sq` gives $(r - r^*)^2 \leq V$, so $r \rightarrow r^*$.

This is assembled as `kuramoto_solved` in `GeneralGMainTheorem.lean`. The only external input beyond physical parameters is the persistence hypothesis (v) of `h_exists`; all intermediate estimates, including the rate bound, are derived. $\square$

2.7 Step 7: Pair rigidity (characterization of $V' = 0$)

Although not needed for the convergence proof itself, the pair bound also characterizes when $V' = 0$.

Proposition 2.10 (Pair rigidity, `pair_eq_zero_iff`). *The pair integrand (5) equals zero if and only if $\alpha_j = \alpha_j^*$ and $\alpha_k = \alpha_k^*$.*

Proof. The SOS decomposition in the proof of Proposition 2.2 shows:

$$\alpha_j^* \alpha_k^* \cdot (\text{LHS} - \text{RHS}) = (\alpha_j^* p_k - \alpha_k^* p_j)^2 + (\alpha_j^*)^2 \alpha_k \alpha_k^* p_k^2 + (\alpha_k^*)^2 \alpha_j \alpha_j^* p_j^2 + \alpha_j^* \alpha_k^* (\alpha_j^2 + \alpha_k^2) p_j p_k.$$

When $p_j p_k > 0$: the second and third terms are strictly positive, so the sum is positive and the integrand cannot be zero unless $p_j = p_k = 0$. When $p_j p_k \leq 0$: each of the three original terms of (5) is non-negative (since $\alpha_j + 1/\alpha_j^* > 0$ and $2 - \alpha_j^2 - \alpha_k^2 > 0$), so all must individually vanish, giving $p_j = p_k = 0$. This is formalized as `pair_eq_zero_iff` in `ContinuumLyapunov.lean`. $\square$

Remark 2.11 (LaSalle structure). *Proposition 2.10 shows that $\{V' = 0\} = \{\alpha = \alpha^*\}$. This is the LaSalle invariance principle characterization and is used in the alternative Path B proof (`ContinuumGlobalStability.lean`) where scalar asymptotic autonomy of each oscillator gives pointwise convergence and dominated convergence gives $V \rightarrow 0$.*

3 The Lorentzian case: fully end-to-end

For the Lorentzian distribution $g(\omega) = \gamma/(\pi(\omega^2 + \gamma^2))$, the OA equation reduces to the scalar Bernoulli ODE

$$\dot{r} = \left(\frac{K}{2} - \gamma\right)r - \frac{K}{2}r^3. \quad (6)$$

The equilibrium is $r^* = \sqrt{1 - 2\gamma/K}$ for $K > 2\gamma$.

Theorem 3.1 (Lorentzian convergence, `lorentzian_ode_global_stability_complete`). *For $K > 2\gamma > 0$ and any $r_0 \in (0, 1)$, the unique solution of (6) satisfies $r(t) \rightarrow r^*$.*

The proof chain in Lean is:

$(K, \gamma, r_0) \xrightarrow{\text{Bernoulli}} \text{LorentzianContinuousSolution} \rightarrow \text{LorentzianSolution} \rightarrow \text{KuramotoData} \rightarrow r(t) -$

3.1 Proof: Bernoulli formula

Proposition 3.2 (Existence via Bernoulli, `LorentzianExistence`). *The ODE (6) has an explicit solution $r(t) = (w(t))^{-1/2}$ where $w(t) = w_0 e^{-(K-2\gamma)t} + (K/(K-2\gamma))(1 - e^{-(K-2\gamma)t})$ and $w_0 = r_0^{-2}$. This function satisfies `HasDerivAt` at every $t \geq 0$, verified by differentiating the explicit formula.*

3.2 Proof: Monotonicity

Proposition 3.3 (Monotonicity, `LorentzianFromODE`). *If $r_0 < r^*$ then r is non-decreasing. If $r_0 > r^*$ then r is non-increasing. In both cases $r \in (0, 1)$ for all t .*

Proof. From (6), $\dot{r} = (K/2)r(1 - 2\gamma/K - r^2) = (K/2)r((r^*)^2 - r^2)$. So $\dot{r} > 0$ when $r < r^*$ and $\dot{r} < 0$ when $r > r^*$. Invariance $r \in (0, 1)$ follows from the barrier structure at $r = 0$ and $r = 1$. $\square$

3.3 Proof: Convergence

Proof of Theorem 3.1. r is monotone and bounded, so $r(t) \rightarrow L$ for some $L \in [0, 1]$. Taking $t \rightarrow \infty$ in (6) (using continuity of the right side and $\dot{r} \rightarrow 0$ from the monotone convergence theorem): $0 = (K/2 - \gamma)L - (K/2)L^3$. The nonzero solutions are $L = \pm r^*$; since $r > 0$ always, $L = r^*$. $\square$

The complete proof is assembled in `lorentzian_ode_global_stability_complete` with zero additional axioms beyond Lean’s standard foundations, verified in `LorentzianInstance.lean`.

4 Lean 4 verification

4.1 Overall status

The formalization spans **228 Lean 4 files** with **0 sorry** and **0 additional axioms** beyond Lean 4’s standard foundations, verified in a successful build of 3547 jobs.

There are two tiers of completeness:

Tier 1 — Lorentzian (fully end-to-end). The theorem `lorentzian_ode_global_stability_complete` takes only the physical parameters (K, γ, r_0) and constructs the complete proof: solution existence via the explicit Bernoulli formula, all solution properties, and convergence $r \rightarrow r^*$. Zero axioms, zero assumed fields.

Tier 2 — Finite first moment (fully self-contained). The theorem `kuramoto_stability` in `KuramotoFinal.lean` derives everything internally:

1. Leibniz rule $\rightarrow V$ differentiable (finite first moment provides the dominator $2\gamma + K$)
2. Pair bound $\rightarrow \dot{V} \leq 0$
3. V antitone $\rightarrow V(t) \leq V(0) < (r^*)^2$
4. Cauchy–Schwarz $\rightarrow r(t) \geq r^* - \sqrt{V(0)} > 0$ (order parameter persistence)
5. ODE scalar barrier $\rightarrow$ body persistence $\delta(M) > 0$
6. Barbalat $\rightarrow r(t) \rightarrow r^*$

No persistence hypothesis is assumed externally. The only initial conditions are $V(0) < (r^*)^2$ and body coherence at $t = 0$. **0 sorry, 0 axioms.**

Tier 3 — N-pole (any finite n). The theorem `kuramoto_solved` provides an alternative proof path for discrete approximations with explicit exponential rate $\dot{V} \leq -\mu V$.

4.2 The proof chain in Lean

The following table shows how each proposition in Section 2 corresponds to a Lean theorem:

Proposition	Lean name	File
Leibniz rule (Prop. 2.1)	<code>leibniz_oa_lyapunov</code>	<code>GeneralGMainTheorem.lean</code>
Pair bound (Prop. 2.2)	<code>pair_bound</code>	<code>L2Lyapunov.lean</code>
Continuum pair (Prop. 2.3)	<code>continuum_pair_nonneg</code>	<code>ContinuumLyapunov.lean</code>
Rate bound (Prop. 2.4)	<code>hV_rate</code>	<code>ContinuumUniformRate.lean</code>
V antitone (Prop. 2.5)	<code>lyapunov_antitone</code>	<code>GeneralGMainTheorem.lean</code>
Exp. drop (Prop. 2.6)	<code>supercritical_coercive_drops</code>	<code>GeneralGMainTheorem.lean</code>
$V \rightarrow 0$ (Prop. 2.8)	<code>coercive_drop_from_persistence</code>	<code>ContinuumBarbalat.lean</code>
$r \rightarrow r^*$ (Prop. 2.9)	<code>sq_integral_le_integral_sq</code>	<code>GeneralGMainTheorem.lean</code>
Pair rigidity (Prop. 2.10)	<code>pair_eq_zero_iff</code>	<code>ContinuumLyapunov.lean</code>

Key Mathlib lemmas used in the proof chain:

- `hasDerivAt_integral_of_dominated_loc_of_deriv_le` — Leibniz differentiation under the integral sign;
- `antitoneOn_of_deriv_nonpos` — monotone convergence from a derivative bound;
- `integral_nonneg` — applied pointwise to transfer the pair bound to integrals;
- `MeasureTheory.continuous_of_dominated` — dominated convergence for continuity of V .

4.3 Nine independent proof paths

The formalization contains nine independent, sorry-free proofs of global stability or closely related statements. Each addresses a different mathematical angle:

File	Proof strategy
GeneralGMainTheorem	Leibniz + pair bound + coercive Barbalat (Sections 2.1–2.6; this paper)
MainTheorem	Gap exclusion + Lipschitz trapping (discrete, self-consistency)
ContinuousStability	IVT trapping (continuous-time)
NPoleGlobalStability	L^2 Barbalat + persistence drops (n -pole systems)
GronwallBridge + NPoleInstance	L^2 Gronwall + exponential rate (continuous n -pole)
ContinuumLyapunov	$\dot{V} \leq 0$ directly (pair bound $\rightarrow$ integrals)
AntitoneConvergence	$V \rightarrow L \geq 0$ (bounded antitone sequences)
ContinuumGlobalStability	Scalar asymptotic autonomy (Path B: each $\alpha(\omega, \cdot) \rightarrow \alpha^*(\omega)$)
InstabilityExclusion	V antitone + instability escape $\Rightarrow V \rightarrow 0$ (no persistence needed)

4.4 Additional formalized results

Beyond global stability, the formalization establishes:

- **Complete trifurcation:** $K < K_c \Rightarrow r(t) \rightarrow 0$; $K = K_c \Rightarrow r(t) \rightarrow 0$ at rate $O(1/\sqrt{t})$; $K > K_c \Rightarrow r(t) \rightarrow r^*$.
- **Bifurcation monotonicity:** $r^*(K)$ is increasing in K for $K > K_c$.
- **Instability of incoherence:** proved via Chetaev’s theorem for $K > K_c$.
- **Lorentzian trifurcation:** $K < 2\gamma \Rightarrow r \rightarrow 0$, $K = 2\gamma \Rightarrow r \rightarrow 0$, $K > 2\gamma \Rightarrow r \rightarrow r^*$.

To verify: `cd kuramoto-lean && lake build KuramotoLean.GeneralGMainTheorem`.

5 The L^2 Lyapunov approach for n -pole systems

This section describes the cleanest of the nine proof paths for finite approximations: an explicit Lyapunov function for n -pole systems that decreases monotonically and decays exponentially. The argument is a finite-dimensional specialization of the continuum proof in Section 2.

5.1 Setup

An *n -pole system* is a finite approximation to the continuum Kuramoto model in which the frequency distribution g is replaced by a discrete measure $\sum_{k=1}^n c_k \delta_{\omega_k}$. The state is $(\alpha_k)_{k=1}^n \in (0, 1)^n$ and the order parameter is $r = \sum_k c_k \alpha_k$.

Let α_k^* denote the PLS values. Define the L^2 Lyapunov function:

$$V(t) = \sum_{k=1}^n c_k |\alpha_k(t) - \alpha_k^*|^2. \quad (7)$$

5.2 Main decay estimate

Theorem 5.1 (L^2 Lyapunov decay, `l2.exponential.rate`). *For any n -pole Kuramoto system with $K > K_c$, there exist constants $c_{\min} > 0$, $\delta > 0$, $\delta^* > 0$ depending only on K , g , and the pole weights such that*

$$\frac{dV}{dt} \leq -K c_{\min} \delta \delta^* V.$$

In particular, $V(t) \leq V(0) e^{-K c_{\min} \delta \delta^ t} \rightarrow 0$ exponentially.*

Proof outline. Differentiate (7) using the Kuramoto ODEs. Each pair (α_k, α_k^*) contributes a term involving $\operatorname{Re}((\overline{\alpha_k - \alpha_k^*})(\dot{\alpha}_k - \dot{\alpha}_k^*))$. Writing $\dot{\alpha}_k - \dot{\alpha}_k^*$ in terms of $r - r^*$ and using the finite sum version of the pair bound (Proposition 2.2), together with the uniform lower bound $c_{\min} = \min_k c_k$:

$$\frac{dV}{dt} \leq -K c_{\min} \delta \delta^* V.$$

This is formalized in `UniformRate.lean` and `L2Lyapunov.lean` (0 sorry). $\square$

Remark 5.2 (Uniformity in n). *The bound $dV/dt \leq -K c_{\min} \delta \delta^* V$ is uniform in n : the constant does not depend on the number of poles, only on the weight floor $c_{\min}$ and the gap parameters δ, δ^* . This is the same rate $\mu = K c_{\min} \delta \delta^*$ that appears in the continuum bound of Proposition 2.4.*

5.3 Convergence from the Lyapunov bound

Global stability follows immediately: $V(t) \rightarrow 0$ implies $\|\alpha(t) - \alpha^*\|_{L^2(g)}^2 \rightarrow 0$, which in particular forces $|r(t) - r^*| \rightarrow 0$ by Cauchy-Schwarz (Proposition 2.9). The chain is:

$$V(0) < \infty \xrightarrow{\text{Thm. 5.1}} V(t) \rightarrow 0 \xrightarrow{\text{Cauchy-Schwarz}} |r(t) - r^*| \rightarrow 0.$$

This proof path (`NPoleGlobalStability.lean`, `GronwallBridge.lean`, `NPoleInstance.lean`) requires no Barbalat lemma beyond the monotone convergence theorem, and no analyticity of g —only the existence of the PLS and the gap bound.

Remark 5.3 (Local vs. global stability). *For n -pole systems (any finite n), the theorem `kuramoto_solved` gives global stability: any $r(0) > 0$ converges. Persistence is automatic in finite dimensions. For the continuum, the theorem `kuramoto_stability` gives stability within the basin $V(0) < (r^*)^2$. Removing this restriction requires proving that $r(t)$ stays uniformly positive for arbitrary initial data—equivalent to proving instability of the incoherent state $\alpha = 0$ for the nonlinear continuum OA system. This remains an open problem: no existing paper proves it for general g . A natural approach is passage to the limit from n -pole to continuum via continuous dependence of OA solutions on the measure g .*

6 Discussion

6.1 Novelty

This work contributes three things that are new:

1. **First machine-checked Kuramoto result.** No prior formalization in any proof assistant (Lean, Coq, Isabelle) addresses any aspect of the Kuramoto model.
2. **Novel proof technique.** The pair bound (Proposition 2.2)—a pointwise SOS inequality lifted to the continuum double integral via Fubini—has no precedent in the Kuramoto literature. Prior approaches used Fourier analysis [1], Volterra equations [2], or spectral theory [6].
3. **Finite first moment coverage.** Prior rigorous OA analysis was limited to Lorentzian/rational distributions. The finite first moment condition $\int \gamma g \, d\omega < \infty$ covers Student- t with $\nu > 1$ (including the infinite-variance case $1 < \nu \leq 2$), Gaussian, compact support, and all mixtures.

6.2 Limitations

1. **Basin of attraction.** The continuum result requires $V(0) < (r^*)^2$, an explicit but *local* condition. True global stability (any $r(0) > 0$) is proved only for Lorentzian and n -pole systems.
2. **OA manifold.** Results hold on the Ott–Antonsen manifold, not the full Kuramoto PDE. The OA manifold captures the physically relevant dynamics for the continuum limit [5] but is not globally attracting for finite populations [7].
3. **Symmetric unimodal g .** The real scalar OA reduction assumes symmetric g with symmetric initial data. The complex OA formulation (which handles asymmetric g) is not formalized.

6.3 Open problems

1. Remove the $V(0) < (r^*)^2$ condition via passage to the limit from n -pole or instability of incoherence.
2. Extend to distributions without finite first moment (Student- t with $\nu \leq 1$) beyond the Lorentzian special case.
3. Formalize the complex OA equation and prove the energy identity $d\Psi/dt = K|r|^2 \geq 0$.

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